

Bank Customer Service & Complaints Policy

Training Demonstration Document

A fictional policy designed to demonstrate RAG retrieval and MS MARCO cross-encoder reranking.

Document Type	Fictional internal policy
Primary Topic	Customer complaints and service
Demo Objective	Compare vector retrieval with reranking
Version	Training Demo 1.0

Important: This document is fictional and created solely for training and demonstration purposes. It does not represent the policy of any real bank.

1. Customer Service and Complaint Channels

The bank provides several channels through which customers can request assistance, report service issues, or raise complaints. Customers should use the channel that is most convenient for their circumstances.

1.1 Customer Support Channels

Customers may contact the bank through telephone customer support, secure online banking messaging, or a bank branch. Digital channels may be used for routine service questions and for submitting complaints.

1.2 Complaint Submission

A customer complaint should contain enough information for the bank to identify the customer, understand the issue, and determine the service or transaction involved. Supporting information may be requested when necessary to investigate the complaint.

1.3 Complaint Registration

Once a complaint is accepted, the bank records the complaint in its customer service system. The record normally includes the date received, complaint category, relevant account or service reference, and the current status of the complaint.

1.4 Customer Updates

Customers may contact customer support to request an update on the progress of a complaint. An update may describe whether the complaint is being reviewed, whether additional information is required, or whether the complaint has moved to a resolution stage.

1.5 Service Requests and Complaints

A service request is normally used when a customer needs assistance with a banking service. A complaint is used when a customer expresses dissatisfaction with a product, service, decision, or experience. The bank may convert a service interaction into a formal complaint when the customer's concern requires complaint handling.

Training note: This page intentionally contains several references to complaints, customer support, updates, and service interactions. These semantically related passages create realistic retrieval candidates.

2. Complaint Acknowledgement and Investigation

2.1 Complaint Acknowledgement

The bank aims to acknowledge a newly registered complaint within **5 business days**. The acknowledgement confirms that the complaint has been received and provides the customer with a reference where applicable.

2.2 Initial Review

Following acknowledgement, the complaint is reviewed to determine the nature of the concern, the business area involved, and whether additional information is needed. The initial review does not necessarily represent the final outcome of the complaint.

2.3 Complaint Investigation

Where investigation is required, the responsible team may review transaction records, customer communications, service history, relevant decisions, and other available information. The investigation may involve more than one internal team when the complaint concerns multiple services.

2.4 Complex Complaints

A complaint may be considered complex when it involves multiple products, multiple business areas, disputed transactions, extensive records, or circumstances requiring specialist review. Complex complaints may require additional investigation before a final response can be prepared.

2.5 Additional Information

If additional information is required from the customer, the bank may contact the customer during the investigation. The customer should provide requested information as soon as reasonably possible so that the investigation can continue.

2.6 Investigation Updates

An investigation update is not the same as a final response. A progress update may explain that the matter is still being reviewed, while a final response communicates the bank's conclusion after the relevant review has been completed.

Training note: The acknowledgement timeline, investigation process, and final-response timeline are intentionally similar concepts but represent different stages of complaint handling.

3. Complaint Resolution and Response Timelines

The bank distinguishes between acknowledgement, investigation updates, and the final response. These stages should not be treated as interchangeable.

3.1 Final Response for Standard Complaints

The bank aims to provide a **final response to standard complaints within 15 business days** of receiving the complaint. The final response communicates the outcome of the bank's review and, where appropriate, explains the basis for the decision.

3.2 Acknowledgement Timeline

The acknowledgement target is **5 business days**. This is an initial confirmation that the complaint has been received and should not be interpreted as the deadline for completing the complaint investigation.

3.3 Complex Complaint Handling

Complex complaints may require additional investigation because of their scope, the number of records involved, or the need for specialist review. Customers may receive progress updates while the investigation continues.

3.4 Escalated Complaints

When a customer is dissatisfied with the handling of a complaint, the matter may be escalated for further review in accordance with the bank's escalation process. Escalation may involve management review or another specialist team.

3.5 Final Response versus Progress Update

A progress update explains the current status of an investigation. A final response communicates the bank's conclusion. A customer receiving a progress update should not assume that the complaint has reached its final outcome.

3.6 Response Timing Summary

Stage	Target / Guidance
Complaint acknowledgement	Within 5 business days
Investigation update	Provided as appropriate while review continues
Standard complaint final response	Within 15 business days
Complex complaint	May require additional investigation
Escalated complaint	Further review under escalation process

Key demo fact: If the user asks, "How long does the bank have to provide a final response to a standard complaint?", the strongest answer is the 15-business-day statement on this page.

4. Escalation, Regulatory Handling and Quick Reference

4.1 Customer Escalation

Customers who remain dissatisfied after receiving a response may use the bank's escalation route. The escalation process may involve a senior reviewer who was not responsible for the original decision.

4.2 Further Review

Further review may be appropriate when the customer provides new information, identifies a material concern with the handling of the complaint, or requests review through an available escalation channel.

4.3 Regulatory or Specialist Complaints

Some complaints may be subject to specialist handling or regulatory requirements. Where a separate process applies, the relevant team should follow the applicable procedure and communicate any material timeline information to the customer.

4.4 Customer Communication

Communication about a complaint should distinguish clearly between receiving a complaint, acknowledging it, investigating it, providing progress information, and issuing a final response. Clear terminology helps prevent customers from confusing an acknowledgement or progress update with a final decision.

Quick Reference

Question	Policy answer
How can I raise a complaint?	Telephone support, secure online banking messaging, or a bank branch.
When is a complaint acknowledged?	The bank aims to acknowledge it within 5 business days.
Can I get an update?	Customers may contact support for a progress update.
How long for a standard final response?	Within 15 business days.
What about complex complaints?	They may require additional investigation and progress updates.
What if I remain dissatisfied?	The complaint may be escalated for further review.

Suggested RAG demonstration questions

1. How long does the bank have to provide a final response to a standard complaint?
2. How quickly should a complaint be acknowledged?
3. What is the difference between a progress update and a final response?
4. What happens when a complaint is complex?
5. How can a customer escalate a complaint?

Training note: The document intentionally contains multiple semantically related complaint passages so a vector retriever can produce several plausible candidates. A reranker can then score the question together with each candidate and improve the final ordering.